Proposal: The Digital Speakeasy

The Hook

Jay Z's "Decoded" taught a generation to read between the lines—to find the deeper meaning hidden in the art. Your brand does the same. It's not just about clothing; it's about a story that starts with a kid from Michigan hustling in a mall and builds into a statement. The upside-down cross isn't a fashion trend; it's a nod to Peter, who felt unworthy to be crucified in the same manner as Christ. That humility, that depth, that understanding that the real meaning is never on the surface—that's the DNA of Decoded. We don't want to just sell that story. We want to build a world around it.

The Problem

Right now, the brand is fighting for attention in a crowded digital space, and it's hitting a ceiling.

- **A Leaky Funnel:** The current Shopify store sees traffic, but visitors leave without buying and rarely return.
- **No Community Moat:** There's no central hub for your culture to gather, turning loyal customers into a passive audience.
- **Stagnant Growth:** Revenue is capped at $2-3k/month, a plateau that optimizing a web store won't break.
- **Disconnected Story:** The power of your cinematic shoots, fashion shows, and podcast conversations is lost online, reduced to a grid of product photos.

The Vision: The Digital Speakeasy

Forget building a better Shopify store. We're proposing something else entirely: a private, immersive world that lives on your customer's phone. This isn't an e-commerce app; it's the digital equivalent of your "3D store walk-in" concept—a destination where the culture lives and the clothing is a trophy earned for being part of it.

The goal is to create compulsive engagement. MSCHF built a $200 million business on a single, powerful idea: every time you open their app, something new, unexpected, and exclusive is happening. That's the core of the Digital Speakeasy. It's a place where things happen, where secrets are shared, and where owning a piece of Decoded means you were on the inside when it dropped. The app is the door, the culture is the party, and the fashion is the proof you were there.

This will be a native iOS application, built with the same core Swift technology we used for the AC Blacksite project, ensuring a seamless, high-performance, and cinematic experience from the moment it boots up.

What This Looks Like

- **The Boot Sequence:** The experience begins the second the app is launched. A cinematic cold start, like a 911 Turbo's tachometer

revving, sets the tone immediately.

- **Hidden Worlds:** Secret mini-games, flash raids on digital locations, and hidden content that can only be unlocked by those who know where to look.
- **Podcast as a Key:** Codes mentioned during your “Real Conversations No Filters” podcast become keys that unlock exclusive content, early access to drops, or hidden features within the app.
- **The AC Collaboration:** A direct integration with your network. As friends with Bad Seed, we can build a channel for joint drops and cross-brand collaborations directly inside the app, creating moments that can’t happen anywhere else.
- **The Inner Sanctum:** A simplified set of core screens: The Feed (the pulse of what’s happening *now*), The Vault (exclusive drops and member-only products), and The Signal (direct, unfiltered communication).

Why Now

The $2-3k/month revenue isn’t a failure; it’s a crossroads. One path leads to incremental improvements—a slightly better theme, more ad spend, fighting for inches on a battlefield you can’t win. The other path is to build the thing that nobody else in your space has: a private world that makes shopping transactional and makes culture the main event. This is the moment to stop renting space on the digital high street and start building your own cathedral.

Investment

We keep it simple. One price to build the foundation, and a monthly retainer to operate and grow it.

Item	Investment
Phase 1: App Build	$8,500 (one-time)
Operations Retainer	$2,500/month

Next Step

Let’s schedule a 30-minute call to discuss the first step.